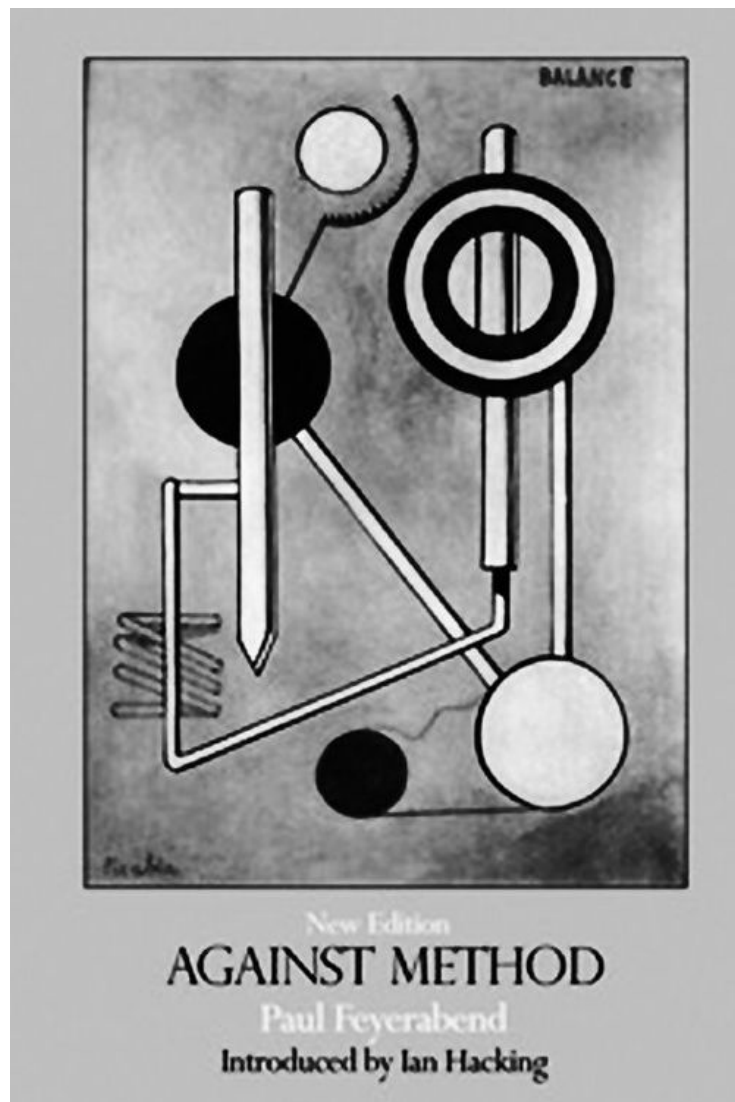


Against Method



Kuhn's depiction of the history of scientific progress as a series of periodic revolutions was given an anarchistic spin by his friend Paul Feyerabend. When a paradigm shift occurs, all the accepted concepts are affected and so, Feyerabend argued in 1975, there is no single, permanent framework for establishing scientific truth. New approaches and methods are adopted and become the consensus of scientists, but they would not have been considered valid before. Scientific progress, therefore, is not achieved by following strict rules – on the contrary, advances are made when these are broken. Feyerabend rejected attempts to justify the scientific method as

Popper had done, proposing that there are no universal methodological rules and attempts to find such rules hinder scientific progress. In particular, he attacked the criterion of consistency with known facts, pointing out that no major theory was consistent with an older one covering the same ground. If science is to continue to advance, he argued, it would do better to ignore any prescriptive theories of methodology.